

Here's a simpler explanation of the Tuna-Dolphin Case I (1991):

1. In 1972, the U.S. passed a law (Marine Mammal Protection Act) to protect dolphins. It banned the import of tuna from countries that used a fishing method called "purse seine" nets, which often killed dolphins.
2. In 1991, Mexico complained to GATT (the world trade organization at the time) because the U.S. banned Mexican tuna. Mexico said this broke GATT rules (specifically Article XI), which don't allow countries to limit imports in this way.
3. The U.S. argued that they had no choice but to ban the tuna to stop harm to dolphins.
4. The GATT panel agreed with Mexico, saying the U.S. couldn't use trade rules to force its environmental laws on another country.
5. However, the decision was never officially adopted, because all GATT members had to agree, and the U.S. didn't.

Here's a simple explanation of Tuna-Dolphin Case II (1994):

1. After the first case, the U.S. expanded its tuna ban to include other countries that used the same dolphin-harming fishing method.
2. This time, the European Union and the Netherlands filed a complaint at GATT, saying the U.S. was still breaking trade rules by banning imports based on how the tuna was caught.
3. The GATT panel again said:
 - It's okay for the U.S. to use a "dolphin-safe" label (because it's voluntary).
 - But it's not okay to ban imports based on fishing methods used in other countries. That's discriminatory and against GATT rules.
4. However, this decision was also never adopted because GATT was replaced by the World Trade Organization (WTO) in 1994, before the decision could be made official.

In short: The U.S. lost again, as the GATT panel said import bans based on fishing methods were unfair—but the decision didn't take effect because GATT ended soon after.

Here's a simple explanation of Tuna-Dolphin Case III (2008):

1. In 2008, Mexico took the U.S. to the WTO, saying the "dolphin-safe" label still discriminated against Mexican tuna, even though it was just a label, not a ban.
2. The WTO agreed partly with Mexico, saying the U.S. rules for the label were too strict and unfair for Mexico, making it harder for them to sell their tuna.
3. However, the WTO did not stop the U.S. from using the "dolphin-safe" label — it just told the U.S. to make it fairer.
4. The U.S. made some changes over time, and in 2018, the WTO confirmed that the U.S. system was now following the rules properly.

In short: Mexico complained the U.S. label was unfair, WTO agreed partly, the U.S. fixed it, and by 2018, the label system was allowed under WTO rules.